

Why Frameworks Exist

Solving Developer Problems

Every framework started as someone's frustration. Rails exists because DHH was tired of writing the same boilerplate for every web app. React exists because Facebook needed a better way to manage complex UI state. Laravel exists because PHP development was painful without structure.

Frameworks are solutions to problems developers kept having.

The Pattern

1. Developers solve a problem repeatedly
2. Someone extracts the common solution into reusable code
3. Others adopt it, contribute improvements, find edge cases
4. It matures into a framework

This is why understanding *what problem a framework solves* matters more than knowing its syntax. When you understand the problem, you can evaluate whether a framework fits your situation—or whether a different tool (or no framework at all) makes more sense.

Frameworks vs. Libraries

Library — You call it. You're in control. Pick what you need.

Framework — It calls you. It's in control. You fill in the blanks.

This distinction matters. Frameworks make decisions for you. That's their value: fewer decisions means faster development. But it also means less flexibility.

Beware Cargo Culting

Using a framework without understanding why it exists leads to cargo cult programming—following rituals without understanding their purpose. You end up fighting the framework instead of leveraging it.

Before adopting a tool, ask: *What problem does this solve? Do I have that problem?*